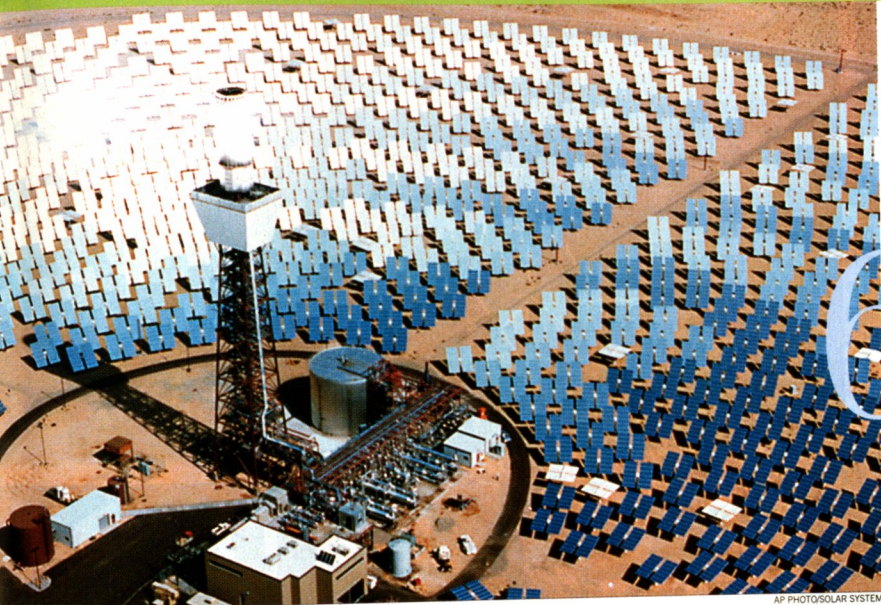


THE DIFFERENCE

WHAT ARE WE DOING TO SAVE THE EARTH? A SURVIVOR'S GUIDE TO CLIMATE CHANGE BY RAJ CHENGAPPA.



Tap the Sun

Solar power plants are truly going mega, both in size and output. Plants that can generate over 150 MW of power are coming up in several countries. Though it does require heavier capital investment, solar power plants are increasingly becoming viable with the rise in oil prices. India should collaborate with major countries to build numerous such plants across the country.

AP PHOTO/SOLAR SYSTEMS

Carbon Tax

Nobel Laureate Al Gore believes that one of the best ways to bring down emission levels is to levy a carbon tax based on consumption. Many European countries have adopted such a tax. Some of them have estimated that the social cost of carbon, as it is called, was equivalent to \$43 per tonne of carbon. In India though with per capita emissions still low especially in rural areas it may be worth exploring imposing such a tax on industries linked to their consumption or use of carbon emitting goods. India already levies a hefty tax on petrol but that's more as a revenue measure rather than to discourage consumption.

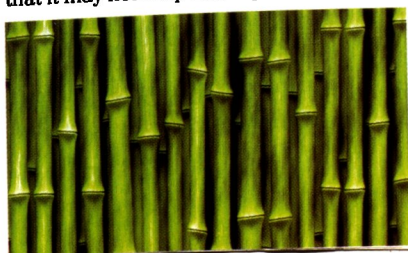
In a New Light

If you haven't as yet switched to compact fluorescent lamps (CFLs) that use one-third of the power than conventional bulbs, then you are living in environmental darkness. The Indian government has launched a massive programme to popularise CFLs by launching schemes to encourage consumers to buy them. It can lead to reduction of 10,000 MW of electricity.



Picket Fences

Instead of concrete compound walls that consume loads of cement and brick, not to mention steel, all huge carbon emitters, there is a rising trend of having fences by growing bamboo trees instead. They are far more eco-friendly and act as great sinks for carbon. Though in India the worry is that it may not keep interlopers out.



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Gobar Times

Community biogas plants are back in business. Cow dung and human waste is used as cooking gas and for lighting in villages. It helps improve sanitary conditions and ends the search for firewood. Over three million plants have been installed.